The Moon · TA Brief

Learning goal: I can explain how the Moon orbits the Earth and why we see different Moon phases.

Watch (staff preview first)

Short silent teacher demonstration clip for this lesson's model and practical sequence · preview before class use.

Adult Support Routine

No cold calling; nobody is asked to read difficult text aloud.

Give time to start -> point to the relevant place -> rephrase -> offer a small prompt or word bank -> reduce to a limited choice.

Beside the You do in the pupil book, mark I (independent), S (supported) or C (choice).

Must-Know Words

natural satellite: a body in space, like the Moon, that orbits a planet

reflect: when light from the Sun bounces off the surface of the Moon

phases of the Moon: the changing shapes of the sunlit part of the Moon as seen from Earth

waxing and waning: waxing means the lit part we see is growing; waning means it is shrinking

Key Answers

A. Half the Moon is still lit by the Sun, but that lit half faces the Sun while the dark side faces Earth.

A. Normal phases happen because half of the Moon faces away from the Sun; we see different amounts of the lit half as it orbits Earth.

1. About 28 days. 2. Sunlight reflected off the Moon's rocky surface. 3. When the Moon is opposite the Sun, the entire sunlit half of the Moon faces toward the Earth.